

Chapter 65-5

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That evening, Liang Shi sent Rainbow back to her home. When she saw Zhou Li, the other woman gave her a box of fresh strawberries.

They were large, juicy, and bright red—they looked delicious.

Ling Dang sat in the car staring at the strawberries. She first said she wanted to save them for her aunt, but then remembered, "Auntie, isn't Auntie unable to eat strawberries?"

"She can't even look at them." Liang Shi said, "So you need to finish them before we get home."

Ling Dang touched her already round and full tummy. "But I can't finish them all."

"We'll share." Liang Shi drove back to Shallow Water Bay but didn't get out of the car. She just sat in the car with Ling Dang, sharing the strawberries.

Ling Dang kept saying she couldn't eat anymore, but then couldn't help saying, "These are really yummy."

Liang Shi thought she was being dramatic. A child like Ling Dang—what hadn't she eaten before?

She raised an eyebrow. "Maybe it's because they're from someone else's house, so they taste extra good?"

Ling Dang nodded, her eyes showing a hint of mischief. "I think Rainbow's mom is so gentle, just like my mom."

Liang Shi didn't understand her sudden change of topic. "So?"

Ling Dang giggled. "Then why is Rainbow so stuffy while I'm so cute?"

Liang Shi: "..."

When she said this, there wasn't any malice—it seemed like teasing, and also like acting cute and playful.

Her eyes curved into crescents, just like the moon in the sky—absolutely adorable.

Liang Shi felt both helpless and like her heart was about to melt.

She couldn't even think of how to respond to that.

What Xu Qingzhu saw when she pushed open the door was Liang Shi helplessly yet dotingly lifting Ling Dang out of the car, then tapping her nose. "You've really got me beat."

Said with complete sincerity.

Xu Qingzhu had changed into loungewear—a long slip dress with a long cardigan over it. The silver necklace around her neck glittered under the dim yellow light. Her hair was casually tied up, very loose, looking languid and casual.

She leaned against the doorframe, arms crossed, the corners of her mouth unable to help but curve upward.

The moment Ling Dang saw her, she immediately waved. "Auntie!"

Xu Qingzhu greeted her back. "Long time no see, little Ling Dang."

Liang Shi knelt on one knee at the entryway to change Ling Dang's shoes into slippers. After changing them, Ling Dang still wanted Liang Shi to carry her to the living room.

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu watched from behind them, quite puzzled. "You've already changed your shoes, why do you still need your auntie to carry you?"

Ling Dang buried her head in Liang Shi's neck and sniffed like a little puppy. "Auntie smells so nice."

As soon as she lifted her head, Xu Qingzhu noticed the red marks at the corner of her mouth. She pulled out a tissue and carefully wiped it off. "You two were sneaking food behind my back."

"Mm." Ling Dang held up one finger. "Just a little bit."

Even though an Alpha had good stamina, constantly carrying Ling Dang was still quite taxing.

After all, she was a five-year-old child—no matter what, she still weighed several dozen jin.¹

After putting her on the sofa, Liang Shi was a bit out of breath, and a thin layer of sweat had appeared on her forehead. Xu Qingzhu handed her a tissue.

As soon as Liang Shi lowered her head, she noticed a small red stain on the shoulder of her clothes.

The "evidence" that Ling Dang had left on her.

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She smiled helplessly. "Sneaking food and not even knowing to wipe your mouth clean."

Ling Dang stuck her tongue out at her, then sat on the sofa to watch TV.

Footnotes:

¹ "Jin" (斤) - A Chinese unit of weight measurement. One jin equals 500 grams or approximately 1.1 pounds. "Several dozen jin" would mean the child weighs somewhere around 20-30+ kilograms (44-66+ pounds), which is typical for a five-year-old.

